



Impact Report 2025

Reimagining fundraising and investing through education, community, and access.

Building informed founders, prepared funders, and durable ecosystems

Founded by Ila B Corcoran | 2025 Year in Review

YEAR IN REVIEW

From Experimentation to Infrastructure

2025 marked Sengo's official platform launch and first grant cycle

Transitioned from research and pilots (2024) to repeatable, technology-enabled programs

Introduced readiness tools that help founders assess, prepare, and decide if and when to raise

Served founders, funders, and partners across the U.S. and internationally

Core shift: From "access to capital" → readiness for capital

KEY METRICS

Headline Impact

600+

Members across Explorer,
Founder, Funder &
All-Access tiers

8,000+

Email subscribers
(from 157 in Jan 2025)

\$31,250

Grants deployed to
underrepresented founders

\$5M+

Follow-on capital
influenced by
supported founders

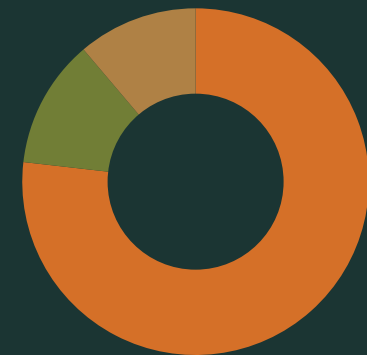
29

Events hosted
globally

DATA & TRENDS

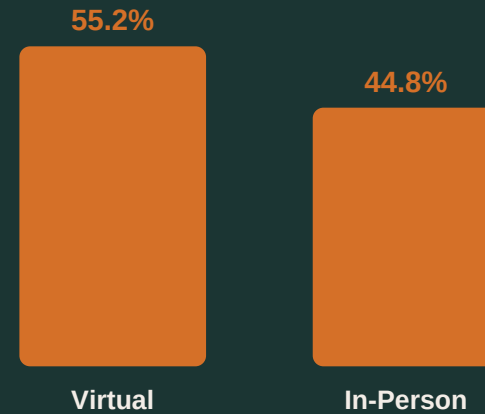
Charts & Breakdown

Grant Deployment Breakdown



- Standard Grants 76.8%
- Pitch Competition 12.0%
- Micro/Mini Grants 11.2%

Programming Mix



Strong engagement across programs

DATA & TRENDS

Charts & Breakdown (Continued)

Email engagement across 2025 campaigns

90,678

Emails Delivered

42,150

Emails Opened

46.5%

Open Rate

*Open rate significantly above the industry average of ~21.33%**

*Source: Mailchimp Email Marketing Benchmarks, 2024 — average open rate across all industries: 21.33%

29 TOUCHPOINTS

Events for Learning, Alignment & Trust

Virtual Events (14 + 2 partner)

Welcome to Sengo Webinar — May 21

Debt vs. Bootstrapping with IFundWomen — Jun 3

Debt vs. Bootstrapping with IFundWomen — Jul 15

Founder Meetup: Social Enterprise — Jul 22

Ask an Angel with Mandy Bynum — Jul 31

Practice Your Pitch with Sarah Anto — Aug 12

Preparing to Raise Capital with Forecastr — Sep 4

Private Markets 101 (Part 1) — Sep 9

Founder Meetup: Angels & VCs — Sep 18

Virtual Pitch for \$1,000 — Sep 25

Demystifying CDFI Funding with Isaiah Coleman — Oct 14

Pitch Prep with Amiah Shepherd — Oct 23

Virtual Pitch for \$1,000 — Oct 30

Virtual Pitch for \$1,000 (CPG Edition) — Nov 20

Building to Scale/Sell with Brianna Arps — Dec 4

Build 2026 Pitch Strategy with Dana Ammons — Dec 11

In-Person Events (13)

Dallas Galentine's Wine Club — Feb 21

Barcelona, Spain Entrepreneurs Mixer — Mar 13

Dallas Brunch Wine Club — Mar 15

San Bernardino Founder/Funder Fireside — Mar 28

Dallas Sip Into Spring — Mar 30

Dallas Wine Club — Apr 9

San Bernardino Funded & Fearless Workshop — Apr 26

New York GirlMath x Sengo at NY Tech Week — Jun 4

Massaguel, France "The Village Retreat" — Jun 10–15

Los Angeles Fashion x Futures — Jun 28–29

New York Fashion x Futures — Jul 26–27

Los Angeles Spill the Tea: AI & Tech Week — Oct 14

Los Angeles Fashion x Futures — Nov 8–9

Thank You to Our 2025 Partners and Sponsors

+ more

Key Insight: Events are most effective when they lead into readiness tools and structured next steps.

SUCCESS STORIES

Case Studies

JB

Versed Wellness

Founder: Jasmine Bowie | Grant: \$500 Micro-Grant

- Concept → physical prototype
- 25 new customers acquired
- Revenue increased post-grant
- Founder chose not to raise capital prematurely

Why it matters: Readiness includes knowing when not to fundraise

SA

Sally's

Founder: Sophia Afullo | Grant: \$3,000 Standard Grant

- 100+ customers acquired
- Production capacity expanded
- Revenue increased post-Sengo
- Founder raised capital post-Sengo

Why it matters: Prepared founders convert early support into scalable outcomes.

Join our email list



bysengo.com

IN THE NEWS

Published Media & Press

Our work has received international recognition and press.

Press & Features

Forbes
Black Enterprise
Entrepreneur
TechCrunch

[+ more](#)

Speaking & Panels

NY Tech Week
Fashion x Futures
Startup conferences
Industry panels
Fireside chats

Thought Leadership

Published articles
Contributed pieces
Podcast appearances
Community education
Research insights

HOW WE WORK

Readiness-First Capital Infrastructure

Sengo is built around preparation before participation.

Technology:

Fundraise Readiness Score · Personalized Fundraise Roadmap

Human Support:

1:1 advisory for founders at key inflection points

Community Layer:

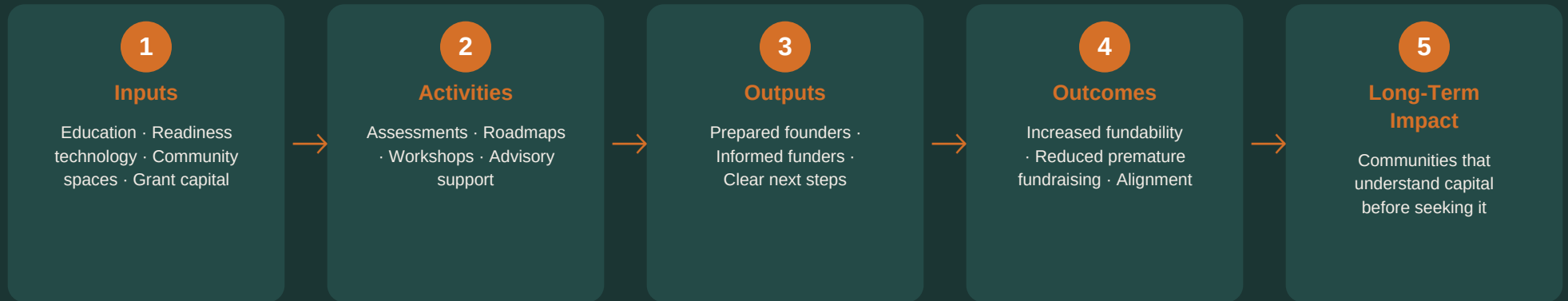
Education, events, and peer learning



Result: Better decisions, stronger outcomes, and healthier capital relationships.

WHY IT MATTERS

How Readiness Drives Impact



WHAT WE RUN TODAY

Core Programs

01

Fundraise Readiness Score

A self-guided assessment to evaluate preparedness

02

Fundraise Roadmap (1:1 Clients)

Customized plans based on stage, goals, and gaps

03

Membership Platform

Education, tools, and community access

04

Events & Third Spaces

Structured learning + relationship-building

05

Grant Programs

Flexible, non-dilutive capital to support readiness

REFLECTIONS

What 2025 Taught Us

What We Learned

- 01 Readiness beats access
- 02 Events without follow-through create noise
- 03 Founders value clarity over volume
- 04 Pay-to-play limits discovery of strong builders
- 05 Small capital, deployed intentionally, creates outsized outcomes

Our Response

- Fewer, clearer programs
- Free readiness tools for members & non-members
- Deeper 1:1 support at critical moments

LOOKING AHEAD

Deepening the Infrastructure

- 1 Expand readiness technology & impact tracking
- 2 Increase investor participation through education
- 3 Scale repeatable programs into new cities
- 4 Strengthen longitudinal data on founder outcomes
- 5 Continue prioritizing clarity, timing, and alignment

GET INVOLVED

Build With Us

Join the Sengo community

Partner on readiness, education, or grants

Attend an event or workshop

Support founders building with intention

Sengo is reimagining the way communities fundraise and invest by opening access.

SENGO · Founded by Ila B Corcoran · 2025